



THE AUSTRALIAN **BUILD-TO-RENT** SUCCESS SUMMIT

19–20 February 2026
Eora / Sydney

Defining Success in Australia's Operational Real Estate

Featured Speakers



Michael Camerlengo
Deputy Chief Investment
Officer & Executive Leader
Clients and Capital
Housing Australia



Matt Woodland
Managing Director
Greystar Australia



Trina Jones
NSW Rental Commissioner
NSW Fair Trading



Lizzie Wheeler
Executive General Manager
Essence Communities



Luke Mackintosh
Partner, Project &
Infrastructure Advisory
BDO



Anouk Darling
Chief Executive Officer
Scape Australia

Media Partner



Define the future of operational real estate in 2026

With housing affordability at crisis levels, BTR is firmly on the national agenda. Governments are backing the model, community housing providers are stepping up, and global investors are committing capital. Super funds are revisiting mandates, while the new MIT tax regime is reshaping project economics.

The **Australian Build-to-Rent Success Summit** will define what success looks like in the purpose-built rental sector. What was once a concept is now a core pillar of Australia's housing strategy, and those who master the financial mechanics of the Australian BTR market will lead the field.

This summit brings together the investors, developers, architects, and policymakers driving the sector forward to examine:

- Feasibility in a high-cost, high-regulation environment
- Net growth through tenant retention, efficiency, and tax strategy
- Migration and demographic shifts shaping product design and models
- How super funds and institutional investors view BTR in 2026

Why Now?

Australia's BTR market is accelerating. With new policies, fresh investment mandates, and the MIT tax regime creating new opportunities, the next 12–18 months are your chance to shape the sector, secure key partnerships, and deliver projects that set the standard for the future.

Whether you're a developer, investor, policymaker, or CHP, this is your platform to collaborate, learn, and influence the market.



KEY SESSIONS

01

Community Building

Learn how to create vibrant communities and improve decision-making to activate sector opportunities.



Julian Anderson, Director, **Bates Smart**



Marcus Greening, Associate | Residential Design Lead, **i2C Architects**

02

Investor Sentiment

Focus on growth sectors must factor in competition for capital allocation, with tax surcharges and policy uncertainties assured.



Puian Mollaian, Co-Founder, Investment Director, **aptResidential**



James Eadie, Senior Sales Manager, **REA Group**

03

Economic Impact

Learn why residential housing was noted as one of the greatest contributors to Australia's economic infrastructure.



Ben Burston, Chief Economist, **Knight Frank**



Ben Martin-Henry, Head of Private Assets Research, **MSCI Pacific**

04

Policy & Regulation

Changes in regulations and streamlined planning processes are crucial to project success. Learn how to align on government policies at all levels



Luke Mackintosh, Partner, Project & Infrastructure Advisory, **BDO**



Veno Panicker, Partner Construction & Infrastructure, **Hamilton Locke**

05

Where is the funding coming from?

A patchwork of capability is required across development origination, deal structuring, and formation of partnerships to bring together the players: CHPs, developers, investors, banks, regulators, government



Ashley Reed, Chief Financial Officer, **MODEL**



Nicola Lemon, Director – Enterprise (National Social and Affordable Housing Lead), **KPMG**

Who Should Attend?

The Summit brings together the key decision-makers from across Australia — the people driving new developments, financing large-scale projects, managing operations, and setting the direction for this rapidly growing market.

- Property Developers
- Banks
- Builders and Project Managers
- Architects
- Local Government
- Engineering Firms
- Private Trusts
- Community Housing Providers
- Superfunds



SPEAKERS



Michael Camerlengo
Deputy Chief Investment
Officer & Executive Leader
Clients and Capital
Housing Australia



Blake Sly
Senior Director
**Australian
Taxation Office**



Luke Mackintosh
Partner, Project &
Infrastructure Advisory
BDO



Matt Woodland
Managing Director
Greystar Australia



Trina Jones
NSW Rental
Commissioner
NSW Fair Trading



Anouk Darling
Chief Executive Officer
Scape Australia



Paul Savitz
Director Living Sectors
Capital Markets
Cushman & Wakefield



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Marcus Greening
Associate | Residential
Design Lead
i2C Architects



Andrew Cooper
Executive General
Manager - Built Form
LANDCOM



Ben Martin-Henry
Head of Private
Assets Research
MSCI Pacific



Paul Nicolaou
Executive Director
Business Sydney



Veno Panicker
Partner Construction
& Infrastructure
Hamilton Locke



Ben Burston
Chief Economist
Knight Frank



Nicola Lemon
Director - Enterprise
(National Social and
Affordable Housing Lead)
KPMG



Paul Zahara
Director
Austar Finance



Emile McPhee
Partner Finance &
Community Housing
Hamilton Locke



James Eadie
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REA Group



Lizzie Wheeler
Executive
General Manager
**Essence
Communities**



Julian Anderson
Director
Bates Smart



Ashley Reed
Chief Financial Officer
MODEL



Tristan Quinn
Principal
Franklin St.



Edward McAuliffe
Director of Residential
Development &
BTR Operations
**Salta Properties
Pty Ltd**



Mitchell Tayt
General Manager
Build to Rent
Goldfields Group



Mark Hayward
Executive Group
Director- Homes
Housing Choices
Australia

DAY ONE | THURSDAY, 19 FEBRUARY 2026

8:00 Registration Opens

8:45 Welcome to Country

9:00 Introduction and Overview

INVESTMENT AND PERFORMANCE BENCHMARKING

- 9:10 Fireside Chat: Recipe for Access Unlocking Capability to Expand Housing Capacity**
- Defining the key ingredients for successful Build-to-Rent community projects through partnerships and long-term planning
 - De-risking projects to attract long-term institutional capital required for delivering development rapidly without sacrificing quality
 - Outlining what BTR housing investment means more broadly than stronger lease security and stability that Australian families need
- Michael Camerlengo**, Deputy Chief Investment Officer & Executive Leader Clients and Capital, **Housing Australia**
Puian Mollaian, Co-Founder, Investment Director, **aptResidential**
- 10:00 Keynote: Australia's First Wave of Build-to Rent Performance Unpacked**
- Analysing the real-world impact of interest rates, cap rates, and negative leverage on initial project returns
 - Insights on the true cost of delivery, from labour and materials to the hidden costs of planning delays
 - Benchmarking actual asset performance: Are lease-up velocity and stabilised yields meeting pro-forma expectations?
- Matt Woodland**, Managing Director, **Greystar Australia**
- 10:30 Morning Tea & Coffee**

POLICY, PLANNING, AND TAXATION

- 11:00 State Differences: A BTR Legislative Comparison**
- A granular, state-by-state analysis of planning pathways and their direct impact on project feasibility.
 - Which states are getting it right? Identifying the specific policies that are successfully accelerating development.
 - What are the next critical policy reforms needed to unlock institutional investment at a national scale?
 - Who will build? Bringing together skilled trades through federal and state programs.
- Luke Mackintosh**, Partner, Project & Infrastructure Advisory, **BDO**
Veno Panicker, Partner Construction & Infrastructure, **Hamilton Locke**
- 11:45 Designing Investments for Community and Competitive Advantage**
- Suburbs beyond the CBD with the highest demand for quality rental products
 - What foreign capital wants: Understanding the specific performance and ESG metrics that global investors are underwriting
 - Designing for the entire lifecycle: How can one asset effectively appeal to demographics from young professionals to downsizers?
- Tristan Quinn**, Principal, **Franklin St.**
- 12:15 Keynote: Tax Structures for Operational Real Estate**
- A practical guide to accessing the 4% accelerated capital works deduction and the 15% concessional MIT withholding tax rate to support project feasibility.
 - De-risking Your Project & Understanding the Commissioner's Discretion: the practical steps for rectification to safeguard your project's eligibility in the face of unforeseen challenges.
 - An overview of the affordable tenancy requirements, lodgement processes, and the critical clawback provisions to ensure your project remains compliant.
- Blake Sly**, Senior Director, **Australian Taxation Office**

12:45 Networking Lunch

MASTERING THE DEVELOPMENT AND DELIVERY PIPELINE

- 1:45 Build-to-Rent Delivering Security, Quality, and Community**
- Analysing case studies of projects delivering quality housing for middle-income Australia in key urban corridors
 - Demonstrating the economic benefits of providing secure, high-quality housing as a requirement of the development
 - How can developers deliver affordability while still meeting institutional return hurdles?
- Edward McAuliffe**, Director of Residential Development & BTR Operations, **Salta Properties Pty Ltd**
- 2:15 The Depth on Leasehold Communities: Analysis of the Diverse Renter Market**
- Which markets are seeing the most demand for rental products? Which products are most desirable in these markets? Pinpointing which markets are seeing the highest demand for different BTR products
 - Understanding the performance and metrics that foreign capital is looking for in a BTR product
 - Developing housing that appeals to the entire renter lifecycle, from first-timers to downsizers
- Anouk Darling**, Chief Executive Officer, **Scape Australia**
Paul Savitz, Director Living Sectors Capital Markets, **Cushman & Wakefield**
- 3:00 Afternoon Tea**

THE GLOBAL AND DOMESTIC CAPITAL LANDSCAPE

- 3:20 Forecasting BTR Demand and the Direct Impact of Migration on Housing**
- Analysing how current and future immigration trends are set to directly impact housing demand
 - Understanding the housing habits and preferences of new Australians to inform product design
 - A practical guide on how to factor economic changes into financial models to accurately underwrite future rent growth
- Ben Burston**, Chief Economist, **Knight Frank**
Ben Martin-Henry, Head of Private Assets Research, **MSCI Pacific**
- 4:05 Panel: Applying Global Urban Planning Lessons to Australian BTR**
- Examining how mature BTR markets like the UK and US have integrated BTR into urban planning
 - Key lessons learned from international markets on density, placemaking, and community integration
 - Applying global best practices to the Australian planning and development context
- Marcus Greening**, Associate | Residential Design Lead, **i2C Architects**
Julian Anderson, Director, **Bates Smart**
Mitchell Tayt, General Manager Build to Rent, **Goldfields Group**
- 4:50 Acknowledgements and Closing Statements**
- 5:00 Networking Drinks**

DAY TWO | FRIDAY, 20 FEBRUARY 2026

8:20 Registration Opens

9:05 Opening Address and Acknowledgements

PRODUCT STRATEGY AND RESIDENT DEMAND

9:10 Keynote: The Sustainable Vision for BTR and the Future of the Tenant Experience

- A practical outline of what a best-practice BTR model looks like from the regulator's perspective, from fairer lease terms to improved building quality and maintenance standards.
- Exploring management models to ensure BTR developments provide well-maintained homes for a diverse mix of residents, including low-income renters and secure long-term leaseholders.

Trina Jones, NSW Rental Commissioner, **NSW Fair Trading**

9:40 Getting Ahead When Housing and Land Supply is in Crisis

- Can state-level intervention break the hold of local councils to unlock land supply?
- Discussing new models and potential conversions to lower the prohibitive upfront cost of delivery for developers
- Articulating the economic case for BTR to governments as a key driver of housing and rental supply
- Exploring the key urban corridors where there is great opportunity for BTR developments and what stakeholders need to come together to make these visions a reality.

Paul Nicolaou, Executive Director, **Business Sydney**

10:20 Morning Tea & Coffee

11:00 Blending Social and Specialist Housing for Impact and Profit

- A practical guide to integrating social or disability housing into a BTR project
- How mixed-tenure models can de-risk planning approvals and unlock government incentives
- Demonstrating how to deliver both strong financial returns and measurable social impact

Nicola Lemon, Director – Enterprise (National Social and Affordable Housing Lead), **KPMG**

Emile McPhee, Partner Finance & Community Housing, **Hamilton Locke**

Mark Hayward, Executive Group Director– Homes, **Housing Choices Australia**

11:45 The Ownership Rebrand and the appeal of BTR Lease agreements for the Ideal Resident

- Strategies for creating a powerful brand identity that attracts and secures the ideal resident
- Leveraging technology and data to optimise the leasing process and reduce vacancy rates

James Eadie, Senior Sales Manager, **REA Group**

12:20 Unlocking Debt & Leverage for BTR Projects

- What the banks need to see: A frank discussion on the key factors dictating funding availability, from developer track record to project pre-sales
- A deep dive into underwriting: How are rising insurance, construction, and operational costs impacting lender models and LVRs?
- Bank vs. Non-Bank: Understanding the differences in risk appetite, cost of capital, and structuring flexibility

Ashley Reed, Chief Financial Officer, **MODEL**

12:50 Lunch

OPERATIONS, CAPITAL, AND ASSET MANAGEMENT

1:45 Op Cos In-House & Third-Party Management

- Defining the essential capabilities in operating large scale development from resident experience and tech integration to financial reporting and how to find the right management team
- At what point does an in-house operating platform become more effective and financially viable than a third-party model?
- A practical guide to structuring management agreements to ensure alignment and performance

Lizzie Wheeler, Executive General Manager, **Essence Communities**

2:30 Building the Future of Rental Housing: Affordable, Diverse, and Liveable

- The challenge of rising housing affordability issues across Australia and why BTR is emerging as a game-changer
- Core Principles of Landcom's approach to long-term ownership
- Setting a new benchmark for housing security and the broader community impact
- Why this model matters for everyday Australians.

Andrew Cooper, Executive General Manager – Built Form, **LANDCOM**

3:00 Build to Rent vs Build to Sell: Which works and for who

- The Capital Question: Comparing the long-term, stable income of BTR against the upfront returns and capital gains of BTS
- The Investor Lens: Why negative gearing and tax benefits work for individuals but create fundamental hurdles for institutional capital
- The Market Cycle: Which economic conditions, locations, and interest rate environments favour one model over the other?

Paul Zahara, Director, **Austar Finance**

3:30 Summit Closing Remarks and Key Takeaways

3:45 Closing of Summit



Amazing and confronting topics handled with professionalism and passion.

–Senior Property Advisor, **Maitland City Council**



A highly informative event with a great range of attendees and rich relevant content.

–Principal Advisor, Social and Affordable Housing, **Merribek City Council**

Why Sponsor?

With open plan learning, product demos, networking, breakout zones, and receptions, this summit offers an engaging experience to create industry connections and partnerships. Two days of thought-leadership, strategic meetings, and networking provides executives with a platform to build important business relationships, gain knowledge and solve their latest business challenges.

Sponsorship offers your organisation the opportunity to:



Target housing providers who are looking for software solutions to streamline property and tenancy management and compliance reporting



Provide professional advice and solutions to CHPs to evolve their business model in response to recent policies, regulatory reforms and strategies



Deliver fit-for-purpose design and planning solutions to Builders who are looking to develop great quality, sustainable, and cost-effective homes



Network and educate Investors and developers on the latest design, build and facilities management solutions and technologies



Unlock new business and investment opportunities in Australia's affordable housing market by partnering funding and financing services to CHPs

WHO SHOULD SPONSOR?

Vendors offering solutions to:

- Property & tenancy management
- Smart Housing Solutions
- Business operations
- Navigating reforms, policy & regulation
- Design, construction, and planning innovation
- Financing
- Maintenance and compliance

SPONSORSHIP AT A GLANCE

PACKAGES	PLATINUM PARTNER	GOLD PARTNER	SILVER PARTNER	BARISTA SPONSOR	EXHIBITOR
Speaking	Host a 30-minute keynote address and participate on one of the summit panels	Deliver a 20-minute address on the main stage during the summit	Participate on one of the summit panels	5-minute address prior to morning break	-
Table top booth display	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Sponsor passes	4	3	3	3	2
Client passes	4	3	2	2	0
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Onsite branding	Banner on stage & at registration area	Banner on stage	Banner on stage during the day of your panel	Banner by Barista station	-
Delegate list with full contact details	✓	✓	-	-	-
Package value	\$22,000 + GST	\$17,500 + GST	\$12,500 + GST	\$12,000 + GST	\$7,500 + GST

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Two-Day Summit	SAVE \$600 REGISTER BEFORE 12 DEC	FULL PRICE
Standard Rate	\$1,499	\$2,099
Government Rate	\$1,799	\$2,399
Vendor Rate	\$3,499	\$4,099

[CLICK HERE TO REGISTER ONLINE](#)

GROUP DISCOUNTS

SEND 3 DELEGATES SAVE \$100 PER PERSON TOTAL \$300 OFF	SEND 5 DELEGATES SAVE \$200 PER PERSON TOTAL \$1,000 OFF	BEST VALUE TABLE OF 8 INCLUDES RESERVED SEATING IN PRIME POSITION TOTAL \$11,000
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All prices are in AUD and exclude GST. Early bird discounts are subject to availability.

VENDOR RATE: If your organisation provides a solution or service to the primary delegate market, the vendor rate applies. Vendors and solution providers are not eligible for group or table discounts.

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CONTACT US

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GENERAL TERMS:

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2. Payment must be received before the event date in order to allow you entry.
3. All invoiced sums, including applicable taxes, are payable in full by the delegate to Women Leaders Institute.
4. Payment is applicable when registration fees have been invoiced.
5. Completing the online registration process or a registration form, is considered a commitment by all parties associated to the registration, for the delegate(s) to attend the event.
6. Should a delegate be unable to attend the event a substitute delegate is welcome at no extra charge. However, no pass sharing at the event is allowed.
7. Should a delegate be unable to attend the event and wish to cancel their invoiced registration then this will be subject to the following:
 - All requests for cancellation need to be made in writing to the relevant Women Leaders Institute office
 - Cancellations 15 days or more before the event: a credit voucher valid for 12 months will be issued less a \$250 + GST administration fee will be charged per delegate
 - Within 14 days before the event: no credit notes permitted
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To further discuss speaking and sponsorship opportunities, please contact

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Organised by

